

ANNA NAGAR

Purasawalkam » Villivakkam » Kolathur » Nazarathpettai » Pattabiram » Maduravoyal » Koyambedu » Tiruverkadu » Puzhal » Kilpauk » Perambur » Mogappair

Avadi » Ayyappakkam » Tiruninravur » Nerkundram » Moolakadai » Ayanavaram » Retteri » Padi » Ambattur » Tirumullaivoyal » Aminjikarai » Vysarpadi » Red Hills

A litany of woes at GNG Third Street

A lot leaves to be desired at GNG Third Street at Varadharajapuram in Ambattur. Residents find the road, which lies along the compound wall of Ambattur railway station, unsafe and unhygienic.

They point out the issue of a garbage bin being placed near an electricity transformer as that can cause a major fire accident in case of a spark from the transformer.

Residents also want a gate of the railway station to be locked.

"This is not an authorised entry to the station and we do not know why the gate is kept open. This can encourage commuters to cross the railway tracks. The Uzhavar Sandhai (farmers' market) on CTH Road can be accessed from GNG Third Street. But the path leading to the market is deserted and overrun with vegetation and this gate is located near the isolated path. All these can give room for unlawful activities. Hence, we want the gate to be locked and a proper road should be provided to access CTH

Road through the market," says resident T.Gunaseelan.

GNG Third Street is a narrow and some sections of the street's margins are misused to dump construction debris.

"Besides, tipplers consuming alcohol in the street is a common sight here. This is a residential road. They litter the street with alcohol bottles and plastic cups," adds Gunaseelan.

GNG Third Street at Varadharajapuram in Ambattur.



A brush with acrylic painting

T. ARVIND

At 11, Hannah Maria Pradeep, a Class VI student of Bhavan's Rajaji Vidyashram in Kilpauk, is pursuing acrylic painting and portraiture while developing her artistic practice through formal training, exhibitions and participation in national and international art platforms. She is currently training at Dessin Academy partnered with The Tamil Nadu Dr. J. Jayalalithaa Music and Fine Arts University, where she is learning acrylic and oil painting, portrait drawing, pencil sketching and pen sketching.

Artistic roots

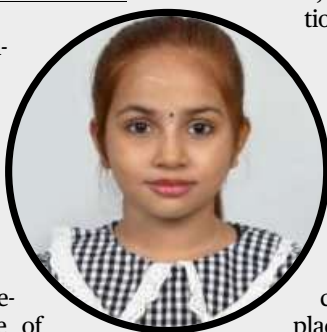
Her interest in art has been influenced by her late grandfather, Jerome Augustus Thomas, a classical artist known for his acrylic and oil paintings during the 1980s and 1990s. Although she did not have the opportunity to learn from him directly, Hannah says his body of

A student of Bhavan's Rajaji Vidyashram is honing her skills in acrylic painting while drawing inspiration from a family legacy in art

work continues to inspire her approach to painting. "Whenever I pick up a brush, I feel as though he is guiding my hand," says Hannah.

Acrylic is her preferred choice. One of her recent works, *The Last Whisper of the Forest*, depicts a young deer and reflects themes of wildlife conservation and environmental awareness.

Hannah's paintings were exhibited at *Colourful Expressions*



2025, the annual exhibition organised by Dessin Academy, where works by students were displayed before members of the public and the art community.

She also secured the first place in the Upper Primary category of A Virtual Cultural Extravaganza, organised by I2OR India in collaboration with Green ThinkerZ India. In another achievement, she was selected as a Star Artist in Artistic Genesis 2026, an international art



event that drew entries from more than 1,200 artists representing 61 countries. According to the organisers, the entries were assessed by an international jury comprising artists from Canada, Egypt and India.

Hannah has participated in The Indian Art Fest, an international platform for young artists, and contributed artwork to the Art for Awareness campaign under the theme India Through My Eyes, which focussed on India's cultural heritage and envi-

Hannah Maria Pradeep's works in acrylic.
PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

ronmental consciousness.

She is also a member of the Children's Art Museum of India and is currently participating in The Giant Hunt, an all-India anime competition associated with a Guinness World Record attempt involving thousands of young participants.

Asked about her artistic journey, Hannah Maria Pradeep said: "I believe every child is born with a special gift. Mine is art. I am thankful to my parents and teachers for encouraging me to pursue my passion and helping me develop my skills."

Hannah's mother, Swetha Margaret, an educationist, said encouraging her daughter to pursue art has helped her develop interests beyond academics. "Her interest in art has complemented her academic performance. While education is important, parents should also identify their children's talents and support them in pursuing their interests."



‘Create a bus stop near Thirumangalam metro rail station’



T. GUNASEELAN

Metropolitan Transport Corporation may consider introducing a bus stop near Thirumangalam Metro Rail Station for the bus routes D70 (Ambattur Industrial Estate - Velachery) 70J (Mogappair West - Tambaram) and 77 (Avadi - Koyambedu).

For the past few years, while travelling towards Velachery, Tambaram and Koyambedu, these services have been diverted at Thirumangalam from their usual route along Jawaharlal Neh-

ru Main Road and rerouted through the interior roads of Anna Nagar.

The diversion was introduced as a temporary measure to facilitate the construction of Chennai Metro Rail's Phase Two, Corridor Five, along the Thirumangalam stretch of Jawaharlal Nehru Main Road.

Under this arrangement, the buses are rerouted through the interior roads of Anna Nagar, passing along 15th Main Road, 13th Main Road, Second Avenue, and Shanthi Colony Fourth Avenue.



Buses on diversion route passing through Thirumangalam metro rail station at the junction of 13th Main Road and Second Avenue in Anna Nagar.

Although the diversion was introduced as a temporary measure, it is expected to remain in force for more than two years and the Thirumangalam metro rail station lies on the diverted route, at the junction of 13th Main Road and Second Avenue.

Despite passing the station, bus routes D70, 70J and 77 do not

halt there. Introducing a stop near the metro station for the duration of the diversion would significantly improve bus-metro train integration.

It may be pointed out that routes 7M, 7H, 147C and 41D already stop at the Thirumangalam Metro Rail Station.

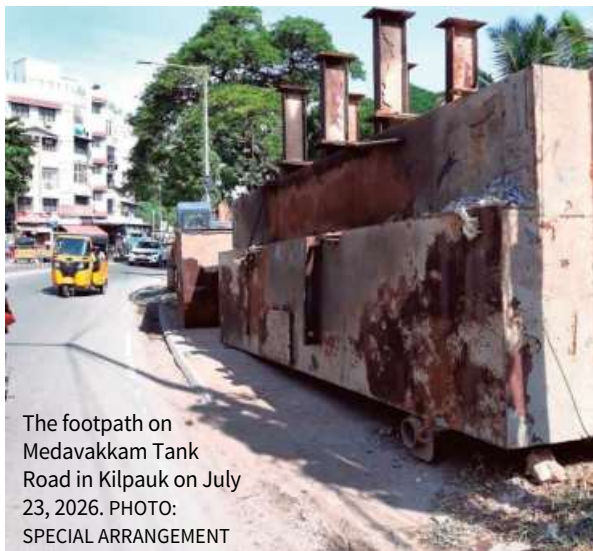
However, these services oper-

ate at considerably lower frequencies than D70 and 77.

Metropolitan Transport Corporation is therefore requested to consider introducing a bus stop near Thirumangalam Metro Rail Station for routes D70, 70J and 77 for the duration of the diversion.

T. Gunaseelan is a resident of Ambattur

‘Machineries occupy footpath in Kilpauk



The footpath on Medavakkam Tank Road in Kilpauk on July 23, 2026. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

D. RADHAKRISHNAN

Stormwater drain work that began this January on Medavakkam Tank Road in Kilpauk is making slow progress.

Equipment required for the SWD work are occupying the footpath. Further, there are other kinds of encroachments including hawkers and parking of vehicles on the footpath.

A rusted machine is a recent addition; it is lying here for more

than a week now. All these force pedestrians to walk on the thoroughfare. Further, iron rods are exposed on the footpath posing a threat to pedestrians' safety.

From time to time, Madras High Court has issued directives to Greater Chennai Corporation to ensure pedestrian safety.

Besides, the Supreme Court of India in a judgment on June 19, 2026 declared that to walk on demarcated and well-maintained footpaths is a fundamental right.

The judgment also noted the fundamental right to walk on demarcated footpaths shall override the privilege of a motorised vehicle and authorities are legally mandated to ensure footpaths are free from all types of encroachments.

Hence, I request Greater Chennai Corporation to clear the encroachments from this footpath and ensure it is safe for pedestrians.

D. Radhakrishnan is a resident of Kilpauk

‘Road in school zone is unhygienic’

JOY M THOMAS

Goodwill Road in Mogappair houses two schools and a college. But the road margins are marked with garbage litter. *Joy M Thomas is a resident of West Mogappair*



Goodwill Road in Mogappair. PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

You can be our volunteer writer

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.



Visitors at Welcome Colony park seek play equipment

The park was reopened this February after a 15-month renovation



The park at Welcome Colony First Street, off Park Road in Anna Nagar Western Extension.

L. KANTHIMATHI

An indoor women's gym is a new facility set up at the Greater Chennai Corporation's park on Welcome Colony First Street, off Park Road in Anna Nagar Western Extension.

According to a tablet at the gym, it was constructed at a cost of ₹25 lakh. The facility was inaugurated this February when the park was reopened after a 15-month renovation.

While visitors are happy about the gym, they see the need for a few more amenities at the park.

"There is no restroom and hence visitors especially senior citizens are unable to stay at the park for long. Besides, there are no play equipment for children and outdoor fitness equipment," says Padmavathi Arumugam, a regular user of park, especially the gym.

Visitors also find the park's green cover to be sparse. "The recreational space was in a state of neglect for the past many years. It was desolate and its compound walls were dilapidated. People stopped using the facility. All these provided a conducive environment for illegal activities. But now GCC has given the park a facelift. New compound walls and walkways have been constructed. However, we find the park wanting in adequate number of lights and benches. There are not many plants. Further, the earthen portions of the park are uneven with protrusion of stones. People can trip and fall," says another regular visitor.

A Greater Chennai Corporation official says "Measures are being taken to improve the green cover at the park. The possibility of constructing a restroom will be considered."

The park comes under Ward 90 of Zone 7 - Ambattur of the Greater Chennai Corporation.



galaxy A14

Doctors' Day celebrated



Doctors' Day was celebrated at KRM Public School, Sembium, recently. On the occasion, Dr. Velmurugan. G, Deputy Director of Health, ICDS, addressed senior secondary students of medical stream.

He delved on the non-clinical services in the field of medicine and spoke about post graduate courses meant to serve the public through administration. During the interactive session, students enquired about career in the field of medicine, adds the release.

Astronomy club honours students



The Astro Club of Kola Saraswathi Vaishnav Senior Secondary School, Kilpauk, conducted a programme on space science.

According to a press release, 44 students completed the two-year programme. A hands-on experience in astronomy through Stellarium software training, Moon mapping, telescope making, rocket model construction, and an educational visit to ISRO - Thiruvananthapuram were part of the course, adds the release.

The club presented certificates to those who completed the course and honoured them by organising a convocation.

On the occasion, M. Suresh Gandhi, professor and head, Department of Geology, University of Madras, was the chief guest. He encouraged students to nurture an inquisitive mind and contribute to the advancement of space science.

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Metro Rail work on major corridors in Mylapore has cast a shadow on C.P. Koil Street with its goldsmiths, and here is how these traditional craftspersons are ensuring the sparkle is not lost despite poor access to their doorsteps

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Chengazhuneer Pillaiyar Koil Street off North Mada Street in Mylapore can be missed by footwear-clad hooves other than those heading to it aware of what it has to offer, a standout craftsmanship nestling quietly inside. Narrow and hemmed in by non-decrepit buildings, it slips past the eye unless one has known it for what it is: the bling street in these parts. In terms of numbers, both of shops and transactions, C.P. Koil Street is no patch on Edapalayam Street, which winds like a necklace between NSC Bose Road in George Town and Walltax Road in Park Town. While Edapalayam Street is the undisputed capital for gold and other precious metal jewellery-making and testing in Chennai, C.P. Koil Street could be placed in a “family” that includes gold jewellery-making enclaves in T. Nagar and Purasawalkam.

The description of a lane fitting it better than that of a street, C.P. Koil Street (the quickly recognised contraction) is lined with shops of gold-and-other-precious-metal jewellery-making craftspersons strategically interspersed with those selling jewellery. There are flower vendors, and shops selling temple-related items at C.P. Koil Street sketching the classic image of a street running close to a famous temple (in this case, Kapaleeswarar temple), but the one trait that overrides everything else is that of a turf for craftspersons adept at shaping precious metal into wearables. These craftspersons, some of whom also work with silver and zari saris that have gold and silver threads woven into them, draw upon the trust built patiently over generations. At Santhosh Thanga Maligai, the owner M. Padmanabhan is carrying forward a family business that had its genesis on North Mada Street where his grandfather operated for nearly 50 years. In its current location at C.P. Koil Street, the business has weathered 40 summers. And if one does a simple addition math, there is an unmistakable and majestic hoariness to the enterprise. This account of a skill passed down generations is a recurring feature, the story reappearing at different addresses across C.P. Koil Street’s storefront.

A bling street behind barricades

This business cannot get any more family-oriented than it is. It could not be put more lucidly than how Karthik Gopal of Sagunthala Testing on C.P. Koil Street does. “It is a family business started by my grandfather Venkatesh,” and on who has been running it now, Karthik rattles off a list: “My father, me, my uncle, my aunt, my mother, my cousins, my niece... everyone” And that certainly is pretty much everyone in the family.

Just as craftsmanship and ownership are passed down the generations, on the other side of the counter, customer loyalty also follows an unbroken line of continuity, generations of a family getting gold jewellery done at a shop

whose work ethics they trust. This trust is coming in handy as these craftspersons are battling challenges arising from a mammoth civic work just beyond C.P. Koil Street’s doorsteps.

Finding itself in the long shadows of Metro rail work all around it, C.P. Koil Street might be a little less hoofed now, but the adverse situation has not significantly detracted from its glitter. The trust factor carries the day for these craftspersons as floating customers have dwindled on account of access unwittingly restricted by Metro rail work on main corridors in Mylapore, examples being Kutchery Road, Luz Church Road and RK Mutt Road.

“Now, almost all roads leading to the street have been affected by Metro rail work. Our regular customers still return because they know us,” says Karthik, noting that accessibility as a whole has been a difficult hurdle to bypass. Years of dedication and craftsmanship have earned them a loyal customer base. However, reputation alone cannot replace the steady stream of first-time visitors the place once enjoyed. “Seven years ago, there was much more footfall,” Karthik recalls. Being overly dependent on your established customer base with little scope for new customers swelling it can bring about a frustrating clinginess and a tendency to want to play Aladdin’s servile genie to those loyal customers from the past. Padmanabhan says his shop is open all days of the week, from 10.30 a.m. to 8.30 p.m.; and they close for work only on two festival days in a year. This challenge plonks alongside others faced by all goldsmiths, particularly those in south India, in Karthik’s view. While technology would have brought a cutting edge of accuracy and speed to the goldsmith’s job, Karthik notes, customers still prefer the sight of a goldsmith seated in front of them and testing and assessing the precious

In the run-up to Madras Day, a look at how a narrow, hidden street associated with a form of time-tested craftsmanship is holding on to its legacy against the backdrop of a civic work that has disrupted commerce in the region

metal. It is down to trust issues, he points out. Laser technology makes jewellery-making swift, but too many people cannot be allowed to stay around lest there could be spread of dust. Those who work with this technology are in the right gear for it. The challenge lies in making the process effective through technology and at the same time making it reassuringly visible for the customer.

A picture of sameness

“The street has not changed much,” says Karthik. Padmanabhan echoes that sentiment in a tone that rings wistful. “There has been no development. The street remains the same, and its narrowness leaves little scope for change,” says Padmanabhan. And perhaps that is what makes the present struggle so striking and relevant. The businesses remain where they started and the community they created continues to seek them. It is the journey moving forward that has become increasingly difficult for them. Preserving the place’s commercial character also means preserving the ease with which people, the outsiders, can be a part of it. And at present, that is a challenge.



A small number of apartment communities in Chennai now offer an impressive 1:1 EV charger-to-parking ratio thanks to developers future-focussed in their thinking. Even these developers admit they are on a learning curve, trying to grapple with technology to make their offering even more meaningful

Towards a fully 'charged up' parking space

LIFFY THOMAS

When a large apartment complex goes big on EV adoption, providing a dedicated charging point at every parking slot, the move will have far-reaching benefits. For one, it would give impetus to the Tamil Nadu government's October 2025 mandate requiring charging point for every individual car and two-wheeler parking space in residential buildings.

Here are two builders who saw the need for personalised charging points even before the State Government came up with this mandate.

In 2022-23, Radiance Group announced launch of the 234-unit Radiance Majestic in Valasaravakkam with one feature embossed: a one-to-one charger to parking ratio. Eight months ago when residents started occupying the flats, they were happy the builder had made good the promise.

The apartment complex has 10-15 EV owners who make the most of the single phase EV charging point that

delivers 7.4 kW of power when connected to their individual meter. This infrastructure is likely to get more residents to switch to an EV.

The builder is modest to admit they still have some ground to cover.

"We were inspired by projects in Pune and Mumbai to adopt the same in Chennai, but we are still learning as those owning a high end car want a fast charger but we have only provided a neutral charger. As this technology is still evolving, there is a lot that we need to analyse and factor in as more owners bring home an EV," says Gnana Murugan of Radiance Group.

With individual EV plug point at every parking spot, Lancor Infynys, a 290-flat gated community in Keelakattalai has a story of how the teething trouble was overcome. The irritants, which

included lack of output from the charging point, app not getting connected and iPhone not getting synced, were addressed over a period of time. "With technology do expect some issues but it is extremely easy and convenient to charge at your convenience from your own space," says Vinoth Kumar, who owns an electric two-wheeler.

He shifted from a large apartment complex in Pallikaranai to Keelakattalai a year ago to avail this facility. "My previous apartment did not have even a common charging point, so I used to go to public charging stations or borrow from other EV owners who had connected it from their power box," says Vinoth.

Those working in the EV charging network say it is way easier for an upcoming project to provide owners with the basic infrastructure at their parking lot by focusing on proper earthing and electric load capacity than initiating the work in existing apartments.

Nethaji M, senior manager, charging infrastructure at Bolt.Earth, an EV charging network, says all that we ask developers is provide the cabling work by connecting every parking lot

with the resident's individual meter. The charging kit varies from vehicle to vehicle and is provided when the person buys

the EV which can be fitted to the plug point.

"3.3 kW is the basic requirement that we recommend for an individual parking lot, but as the number of EV users increases in a community the extra load must also be planned by coordinating with the Tamil Nadu Electricity Board," says Nethaji.

CREDAI's stand

Confederation of Real Estate Developers Association of India - Chennai had represented to the Additional Chief Secretary, Housing and Urban Development Department, Government of Tamil Nadu that one-to-one charger-to-parking ratio may be "technically unnecessary, financially burdensome, and operationally impractical, especially in large residential developments."

Currently, 7 kW AC home charger has been used as the ba-

sis for EVs priced below ₹20 lakh. With the market fast moving towards 11 kW AC chargers, transitioning from 7 kW to 11 kW would reduce charging times by nearly 35%, sharply improving utilisation efficiency. If 11 kW becomes the norm, the current requirement of having a dedicated charger for every parking slot would result in an overcapacity, nearly 18 times higher, rendering the infrastructure severely underutilised, says CREDAI in their representation. Developers feel rapid technological advancements will outdate today's chargers. EV charging cables, often 30-40 mm in diameter, pose major challenges when routing hundreds of lines across basements and high-rise structures. The cumulative cable volume, ducting requirements, and heat considerations make one-to-one provisioning technically unviable.

A green upgrade, slow and steady

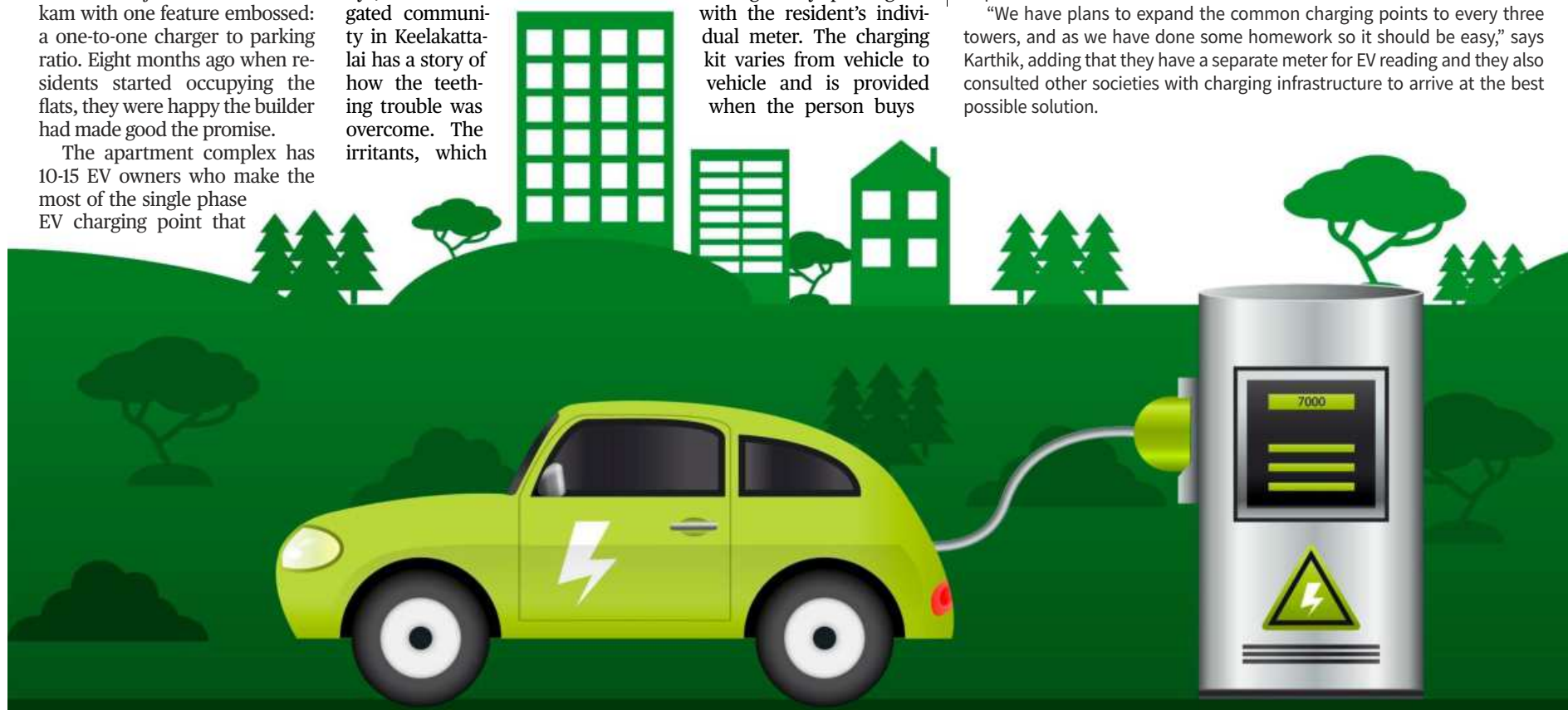
Most older gated communities are not keen on a one-to-one charger to parking ratio for a variety of reasons and are taking baby steps towards increasing the common EV infrastructure.

Brentwood, one of the 13 towers at House of Hiranandani in Egattur, was the first to invest in an EV charging station that was opened to residents from other towers as well. Now, they have another tower, Amalfi, that has also opened a charging station just for cars.

Likewise, DLF Gardencity Cluster 1 in Semmancherry invested in four basic charging devices to meet the needs of both two-and-four wheelers. The infrastructure was installed at a place easily accessible to residents from the nine towers at DLF Gardencity. This year, the Association upgraded the amenity with four charging points for two-wheelers and four others for four-wheelers.

Karthik T.S., a committee member, says their EV journey has been "steady and fruitful". Towards finding out what best suits the needs of the community, they took up a study that included finding out how many vehicles were coming to the community, how quickly the vehicles were getting charged, the EV capacity, the charger that should be used, how many charging stations are there around the campus and the power requirements.

"We have plans to expand the common charging points to every three towers, and as we have done some homework so it should be easy," says Karthik, adding that they have a separate meter for EV reading and they also consulted other societies with charging infrastructure to arrive at the best possible solution.



Inclusive arts to take centre stage at IIT-M on August 2

Can inclusivity be celebrated through art, music and dance? It can - if you were to look at 'Aavaa Dingi', an initiative to empower and develop the underprivileged and economically challenged youth and differently-abled people through workshops, fine arts and cultural performances.

According to a press release, part of the sustainable development project for DCF Global Inclusive Town vision, 'Aavaa Dingi' will witness international inclusive music and dance teams collaborating with local artistes and differently-abled talent to showcase their talent and inspire the world.

After successful drawing/painting and singing competitions earlier this month, the festival heads for a grand celebration on August 2.

The 2026 line-up includes some exciting performances. Apart from inclusive music and dance performances, it will also give away awards in multiple categories.

Columbian singer Evelyn Soto, who regularly tours with AR Rahman, will perform at the event. In addition, the performance will include the inclusive band VFU (Voice for Unity - The DCF Band), comprising 20+ specially talented children, says the press release.

The event will also be supported in person by celebrities

such as popular music composer James Vasanthan, singers Vaikom Vijayalakshmi and Anuradha Sriram.

'Aava Dingi 2026' will take place on August 2, 5 p.m. onwards at Open Air Theatre (OAT), IIT Madras. To register, log on to www.aavaadingi.com



Art against drugs

Fevicryl-certified teachers fan out to educational institutions to create awareness about drug abuse and fight the scourge



BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

A city-wide campaign through art is mobilising students at colleges and schools to speak up about the dangers of substance abuse. Initiated by art and craft brand Fevicryl, the initiative launched recently has Fevicryl-certified teachers visiting institutions

to conduct an art session where students use their creativity to create meaningful works on the theme of drug awareness. The sessions are aimed at encouraging creativity, building teamwork, promoting social responsibility and creating awareness for a drug-free society.

During a workshop at a college in Thiruverkadu.

PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Tejaswitha Singh, a resident of Adyar who is driving the initiative in south Chennai, says, "All what we ask institutions is give them two hours and at least 200 students and we engage with them to use art to create awareness." The materials for the artworks have to be arranged by the students that includes canvas board, markers and other stationery.

A team of three would be assigned to every institution where they are also involved in colouring a 6ft x 3 ft banner with colourful messages.

Besides being a Fevicryl certified trainer, Tejaswitha works as a guest lecturer in fashion designing. She says there are close to 150 such certified teachers in Chennai and they are fanning out to institutions in their respective areas to increase participation in this initiative.

By researching about drugs and its side effects to send out a message on canvas, the initiative nudges students to recognise behavioural signs and be allies with the State Government in combating the scourge of drug abuse.

If you wish to invite the team, contact Tejaswitha Singh at 80560 91498

Amma canteen at Omandurar GH sought



T.S. ATUL SWAMINATHAN

Members of Rajiv Gandhi Nagar Youth Welfare Association in Semmencheri have written a letter to the State government seeking the establishment of an Amma Unavagam (canteen) on the premises of the Tamil Nadu Government Multi Super Speciality Hospital at Omandurar Government Estate.

S. Jayakumar Sekar, a core member of the Association, says, "Every day, the hospital receives many patients and caretakers from various parts of Tamil Nadu. However, there is no affordable food facility within walking distance of the hospital."

It is common to see attenders walking till Wallajah Road and

nearby areas to buy food for patients.

The Amma Unavagam facilities close to the hospital are located approximately 1.5 kilometres away (Arunachalam Road and West Coovam River Road in Chintadripet), making it difficult for those accompanying patients.

Although a restaurant is available at the nearby MLA's Hostel, the prices are beyond the reach of many poor and middle-income families.

The representation was also submitted to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay (Chief Minister's Special Cell), the Health and Family Welfare Department and the hospital administration, requesting establishment of a canteen within the hospital campus, he added.

Inviting married women for 'Face of Chennai'

Registrations have opened for the 15th edition of IRIS Face of Chennai - Mrs Category. Married women up to the age of 50 years from diverse backgrounds can participate to showcase their personality, talents, and unique journeys. Participants will gain

access to expert mentoring, grooming and presentation training, networking opportunities, exciting gifts, and a platform to enhance their confidence and skills.

To register for auditions, contact 98847 83510, 98412 06506

At the ongoing MCC World Records Festival 2026, both individuals and teams are displaying a variety of incredible skillsets

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

Over 1,137 students, 90 staff and 56 world records in the offing. MCC Public School in Chetpet is sporting a festive mood with 'MCC World Records Festival 2026' under way on the campus till July 26. To mark the school's 10th anniversary, six major team world records and 50 individual world record attempts across academics, artistry, athletics and cultural disciplines are happening. Besides showcasing the talent, creativity, innovation and endurance, the Records Festival has ensured every student is part of some event whereby they get to showcase their skills.

For instance, there is Jessica John of Class IX who showcased her mastery with words by penning 200 poems on a range of topics. Her batchmate, Samanta Felix, showed her skill on the court by

playing badminton against most opponents for the longest duration: nine hours 45 minutes.

All the events are being adjudicated by four internationally recognised bodies – Elite World Records, Asian Book of Records, Indian Book of Records and Tamilan Book of Records.

On July 24, students performed a sports drill while holding umbrellas at a single venue. Likewise, there was another feat with vegetable print artwork and solving single-digit mental arithmetic addition problems.

Each of these feats was a display of hard work and mental disci-



And it is raining feats



Students perform a drill holding umbrellas and (below) a kindergarten student showcases his skill with numbers. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

pline.

The idea to bring out a book was floated by a student, Daita Hardikh. The process for 'Most Authors Contributing to a Fiction Story Book Series Published by a School' began in April. Each story had to be 250 words and was written in the school in their notebooks.

Yasmin Khan, teacher with the English Department, says the book titled 'Inspire' is a collection of fictional stories on a range of topics that children relate to and the first version was corrected by teachers of the English department.

The exercise went through many checks and balances to ensure the contents of the story was not plagiarised and each of the authors had to come up with their first manuscript for an interview round.

On July 25 and 26, the 'Longest Bible Reading Marathon' will be conducted for 24 hours.

The citation ceremony will be held on August 1; 9 a.m. onwards.

Jolly Saji Mathew, principal of the school, says the World Records Festival would serve as memory for all. "We noticed that there were so many children with talents and they had to be given a platform where they could showcase their skills individually and as a team, which is what our motto also is 'Achieving Excellence Together'", says Jolly.

Dance workshop by Lester Fernandes on August 1

Noted choreographer Lester Fernandes will be conducting a dance educator in the city on August 1.

Lester shot to fame as a child artiste in Bollywood, where he danced alongside Shah Rukh Khan and Madhuri Dixit in Chak Dhoom Dhoom. Over the years, he became an integral part of the Shiamak Davar Dance Company.

Lester will conduct three exclusive workshops at Fitness & Beyond by Hanny, a contemporary fitness and wellness studio on Flowers Road in Kilpauk.

The day will see a Bollywood workshop for children, followed by a session for adults and conclude with a garba session. The event has been curated by Sheetal Rayathatha and Rishika Pawany.

For details, call 7984556577

Two-day convention on Vedas

Om Charitable Trust will be hosting its 18th annual two-day convention called "National Vedic Talent Vista 2026." The event will be held on August 1 and 2 at Sri Krishnaswamy hall, No.62, South Boag Road, T. Nagar. Lectures on Vedas, quiz, chanting of Vedas, and cultural events are part of the programme. Phone: 95661 95611 / 91766 91111

Drawing and handwriting competitions

Apollo Hospitals and Decathlon - Mogappair along with Sportena Academy is conducting drawing and handwriting competitions on August 2 at Decathlon in Mogappair. Time: From 9 a.m. to 12.30 p.m.

According to a press release, the the event is meant for students from kindergarten to class eight. For details, call 87783 94729 / 8610443961 / 9380869045.

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Cleanliness awareness rally held



To raise awareness of waste management and environmental responsibility, the UNESCO Kancheepuram District and Mangadu Municipality recently organized a cleanliness rally on the theme 'My Waste, My Responsibility' at the National IT

School campus in the Mangadu region.

V. Padmavathy, president, UNESCO Kancheepuram district, and M. Sumathi Murugan, president of Mangadu Municipality, participated and flagged off the rally.

DG Vaishnav College wins basketball title



The team players with E. Vasandhakumar, director of the college's physical education department; N. Sampath, coach; and Arun Subham, the assistant coach. Photo: Special Arrangemen

The Dwaraka Doss Goverdhan Doss Vaishnav College (Autonomous) won the 29th Sree Raghavendra Inter-Collegiate Basketball Championship, held in the city from July 11 to 23.

In the knockout match, the college defeated Jeppiaar University, 72-47; in league matches, SRM University, 67-56; Hindustan University, 71-69; and Madras Christian College, 91-51.

The team showed outstanding teamwork, which paved the way for an unbeaten run in the tournament and helped them to clinch the title and bring pride to the institution.

The results: Hindustan University, runner-up; SRM University, third place; and Madras Christian College, fourth place, said a release.

Workshop on making chocolates

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on making chocolates, wafers, and milk shakes on July 30. Another workshop on bee-keeping will be held on July 31. According to a press release, prior registration is needed. Both the workshops will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, Frist Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy.

For details, call 044 - 29530048.



HGI starts school in Padappai



The Hindustan Group of Institutions (HGI) has established Hindustan International School (HIS) in Padappai to provide a contemporary learning environment that integrates academic excellence, technology, creativity, sports, and values-based education.

Theodosius Mar Thoma, Metropolitan, Malankara Mar Thoma Syrian Church, inaugurated the campus.

In his speech, he underscored the importance of education root-

ed in values, character, and compassion in shaping responsible global citizens.

Anand Jacob Verghese, chairman of Hindustan Group of Institutions, said, "We believe education must go beyond academic achievement to nurture character, creativity, critical thinking and a sense of purpose. Through this campus, we aim to create an environment where every learner is encouraged to explore their potential, embrace innovation and grow into a responsible global citizen while remaining rooted in

strong values."

The campus features smart classrooms, robotics and computer laboratories, composite science laboratories, innovation and maker spaces, and dedicated sports infrastructure.

Two books were released: one curated by Anand Jacob, 'Journey of Parables', a collection of reflections centred on leadership and values, and a coffee table book, 'Historia', documenting the decade-long journey of Hindustan International School, a release from HGI stated.

Course on Montessori teacher training

The Indian Montessori Training Courses (IMTC), Chennai, will commence their 57th Montessori teacher training Course in August.

The weekend course will have online and in-person sessions, a format designed to suit working women, enabling them to balance work and family while pursuing their passion for early childhood education.

IMTC-Chennai is affiliated with the Indian Montessori Center, Bengaluru, which awards the Diplo-

ma to successful candidates.

Over the past three decades, IMTC, Chennai, has quietly supported Tamil Nadu's early-education landscape.

IMTC-Chennai has trained more than 1700 teachers, and over 45 schools in Tamil Nadu have been established by the institution's alumni.

For details, WhatsApp and call 94449 36263, 044-24614301.

Email: admissions.imtcc@gmail.com Visit: <https://imtccennai.org>

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